12. Ibid.
13. First, I discounted the monthly and weekly shakhas—assuming that some people who go to daily shakhas may also be going to weekly and monthly ones. Then, I used the RSS's officially reported number of daily shakhas in a year to make three projections: based on whether the average number of attendees at each shakha was fifteen, fifty or a hundred. The calculation gave us a range of rough minimum (calculated at an average of fifteen members per shakha) and maximum (calculated at an average of 100 members per RSS shakha) range for RSS membership numbers. If we use the middle estimate of an average of fifty attendees per shakha per year, then membership would amount to 29,63,300 members in 2019. Estimate by Nalin Mehta and Rajiv Pundir.
14. RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat said on 10 November 2011 that the RSS supported the Anna-led anti-corruption movement. This is a point made in September 2020 by Prashant Bhushan, one of the key leaders of the movement as well. Also see Ashutosh, 'Movement and the mask', *The Indian Express*, 18 September 2020.
15. Data from RSS annual reports, analysed by the author. In this regard, also see Anahita Mukherjee, 'RSS is on a roll: Number of shakhas up 61% in 5 years', *The Times of India*, 16 August 2015. The data in this report does not match entirely with the data in RSS annual reports. We have gone with the original RSS data. However, data points used in this TOI report indicate the same direction of change, http://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/articleshow/48498034.cms.
16. IANS, 'RSS active in 90% of blocks in India: Manmohan Vaidya', *Outlook*, 16 October 2019, https://www.outlookindia.com/newsscroll/rss-active-in-90-of-blocks-in-india-manmohan-vaidya/1641746.
17. Personal conversation with senior city-level RSS leader in UP, July 2020.
18. A number of shakhas (three to ten) form a Mandal (group of colonies) and a number of Mandals (five to ten) club together to form a Nagar (town/tehsil/block). A number of Nagars form a Zila